



INSIDE TRUSTMRR

What 1,000 Verified Startups Reveal About Small Business Success

A data investigation into the TrustMRR 1,000-Row Dataset · Frozen 30 Jul 2026

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What Is This Data About?

TrustMRR is a directory of small, mostly bootstrapped startups whose revenue is verified directly through their payment processor — not self-reported. Each row is one listed business: a real product, with real (verified) money moving through it.

Some listings are purely informational — a public track record. Others are actively for sale, turning the same dataset into a live marketplace for buying and selling small internet businesses.



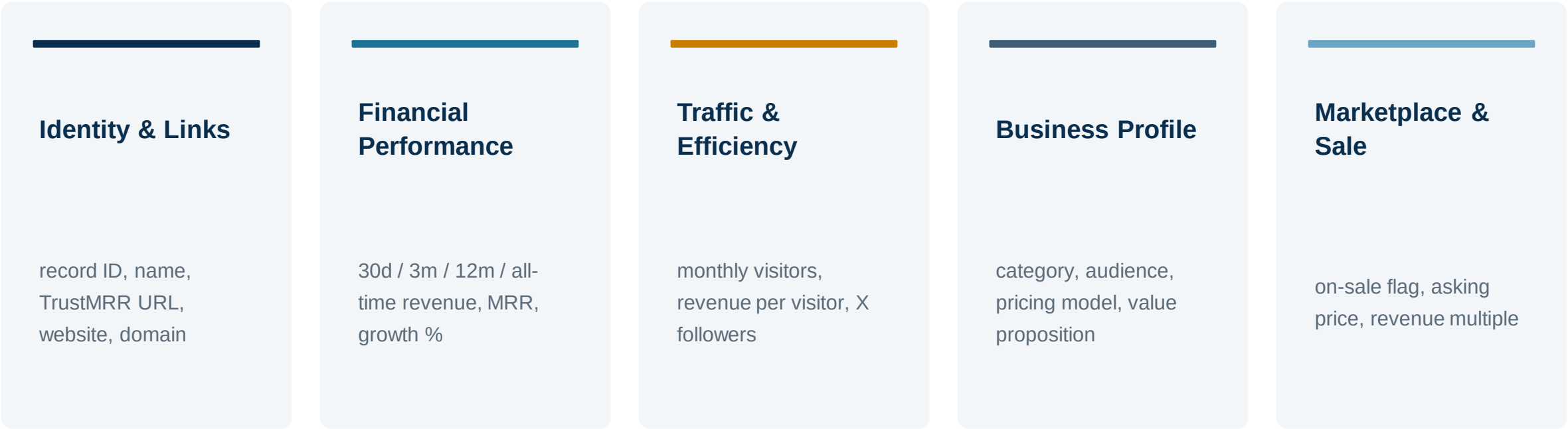
Verified, Not Claimed

Revenue is pulled straight from Stripe, RevenueCat, Paddle, and similar processors — the same trust layer that makes the marketplace usable.

Stripe powers 64% of listings

Anatomy of a Listing

Every one of the 1,000 rows carries the same 29 data points, grouped into five families:



The Dataset at a Glance

1,000

Startup listings

29

Data points per row

65

Countries represented

29

Business categories

26.2%

Currently listed for sale

\$15.6M

Combined 30-day revenue

Why Would Someone Need This?

1

Buy a Startup

Screen the on-sale listings by revenue multiple, MRR, and growth to scout acquisition targets.

2

Benchmark Your Own

Compare your MRR, growth, or revenue-per-visitor against real peers in your category.

3

Study the Market

See which categories, countries, and payment rails are actually generating revenue today.

4

Build Screening Tools

Feed the verified numbers into ranking models — exactly what we did earlier in this project.

SECTION 03

The Investigation

Twelve questions we put directly to the 1,000-row dataset — and what each one turned up.

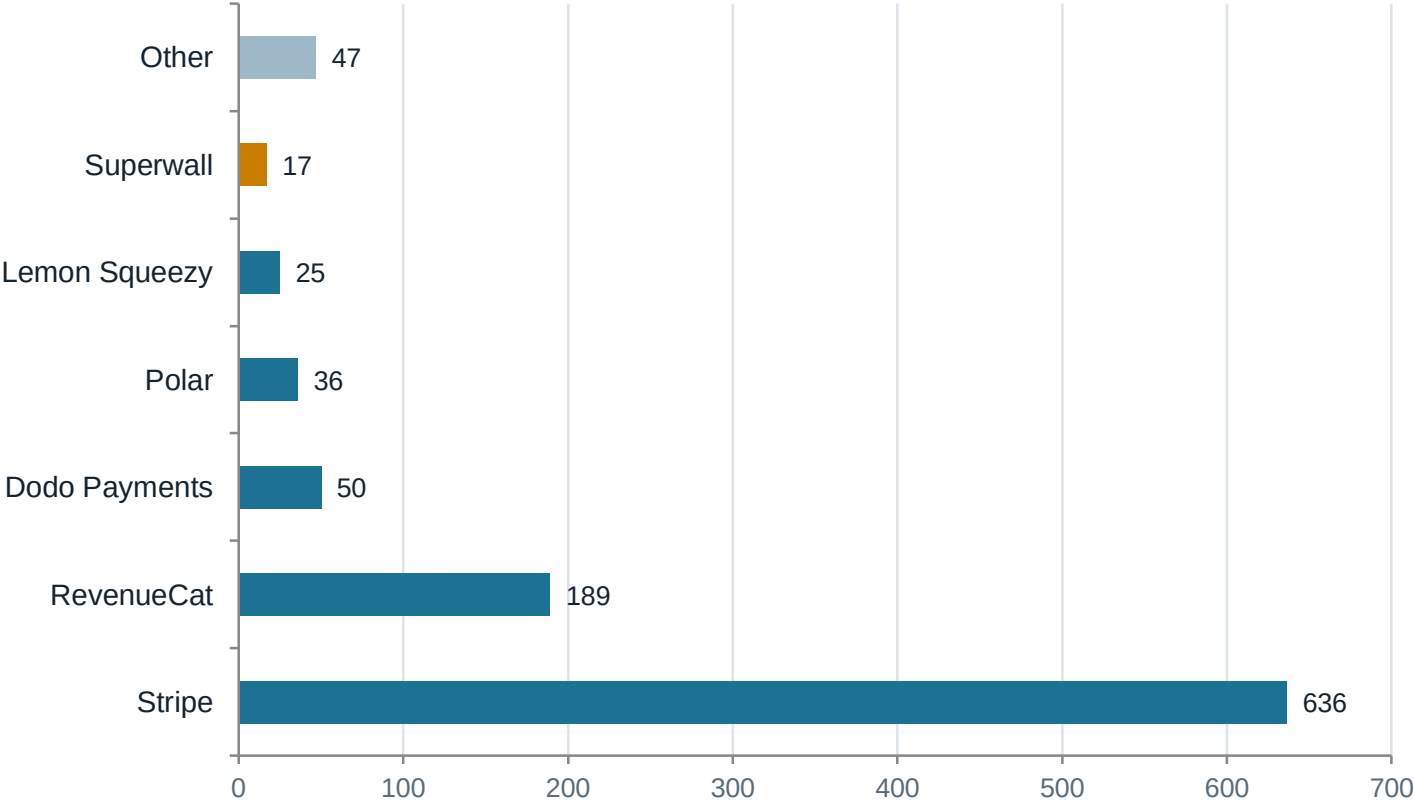
How Complete Is the Data?



28.6%
of listings have no Domain Rating
on file

286 of 1,000 listings are missing a Domain Rating — an SEO authority score that hints at organic traffic potential. Nearly 3 in 10 listings simply haven't been checked, a real diligence gap for anyone evaluating these businesses site-unseen.

Which Payment Rails Power These Startups?



17

listings run on Superwall — out of 1,000

Stripe processes nearly two-thirds of all listed startups — it's the default rail for indie founders. Niche processors like Superwall (mobile subscription paywalls) mark a small but distinct slice of the market: in-app subscription products rather than web SaaS.

Category Spotlight: Dev Tools vs. E-comm

DEV TOOLS

\$163,402

total 30-day revenue across 37 listings

A real, aggregate revenue pool — developer tooling converts into steady, collective dollars even without any single breakout star.

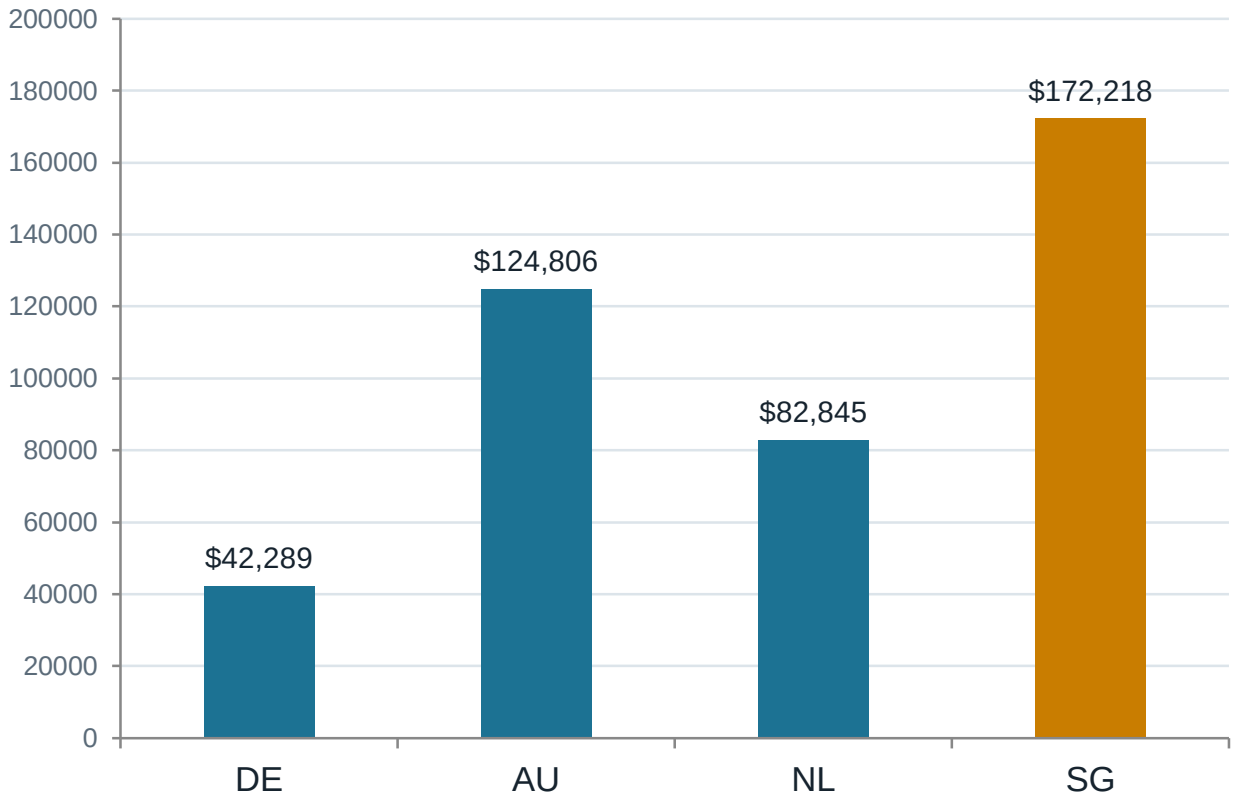
E-COMM

\$155

median MRR across 19 listings (zeros included)

A small sample, and mostly hobby-scale: the typical listed e-comm store earns well under \$200/month — revenue here is concentrated in a few standouts, not the median business.

A Small Geography Sprint: DE, AU, NL & SG

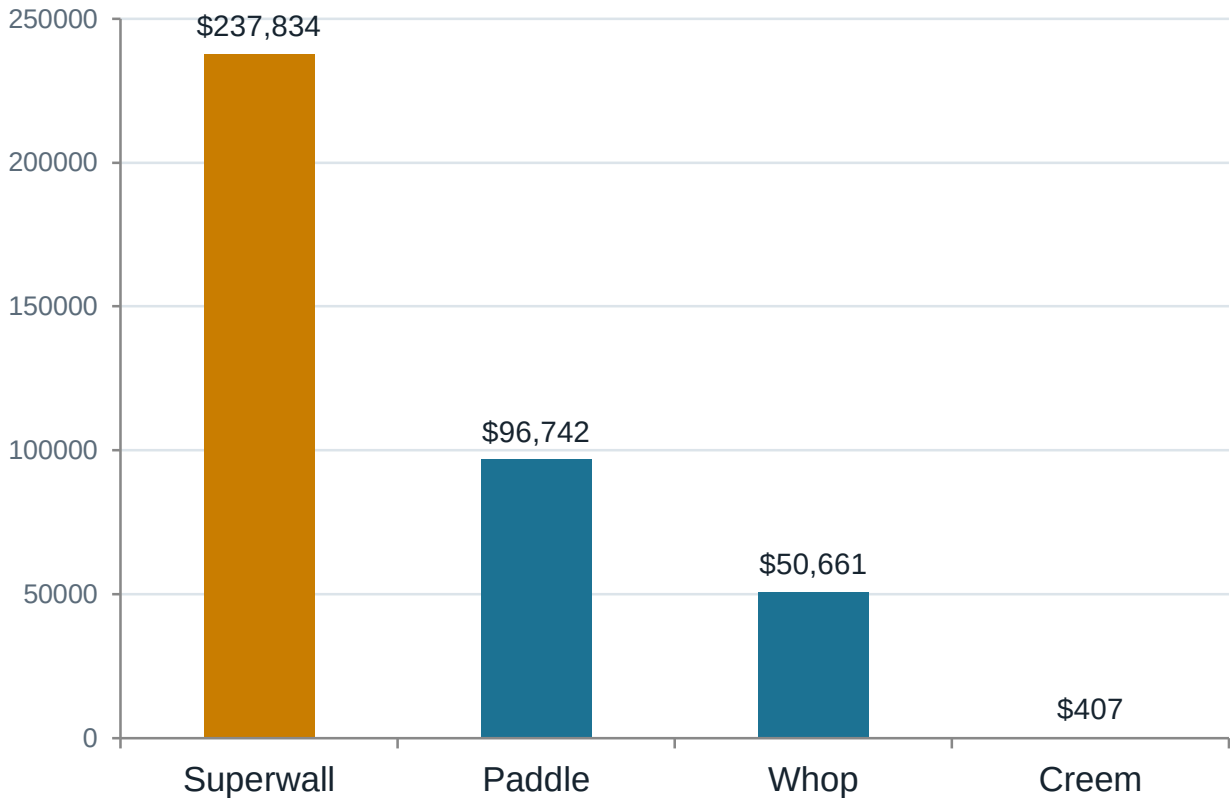


Singapore

\$172,218 from just 9 listings

Singapore wins outright — and does it with the fewest companies of the four (9). Its per-company average revenue dwarfs the other three, a reminder that country-level totals can hide very different average outcomes.

Which Payment Rail Actually Earns More?



Superwall
\$237,834 from 17 listings

Despite Paddle having almost the same number of listings (16 vs. 17), Superwall-powered apps earn nearly 2.5x more in aggregate — consistent with mobile subscription paywalls commanding stronger monetization than typical web checkouts.

QUESTION 07

Hidden in Plain Sight: Anonymous vs. Named

(Anonymous = blank name, "Stealth Company," or "Hidden Business")

ANONYMOUS

130 companies (13.0%)

\$4,191,784

total 30-day revenue (26.9% of all revenue)

\$32,244

average revenue per company

NAMED

870 companies (87.0%)

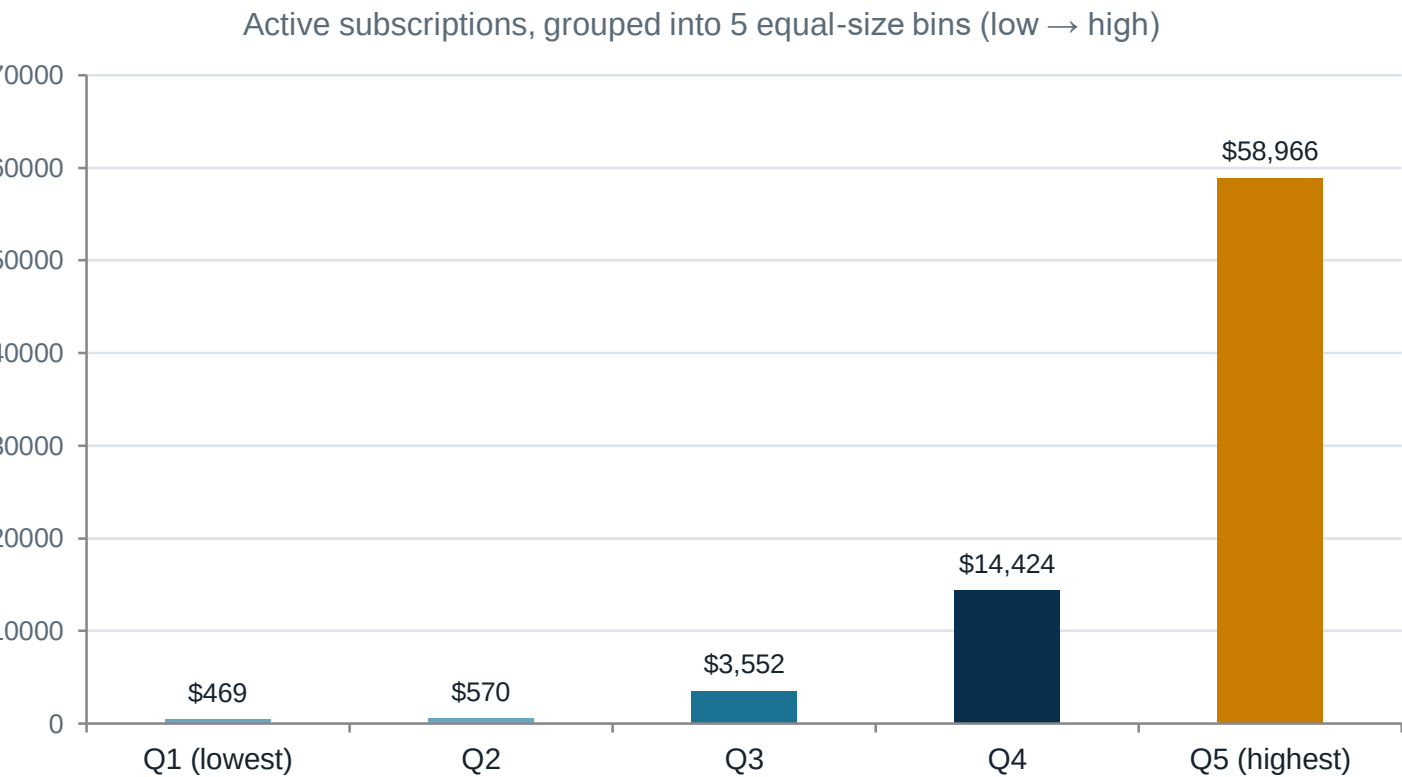
\$11,404,560

total 30-day revenue (73.1% of all revenue)

\$13,109

average revenue per company

Do More Subscriptions Mean More Revenue?



$r = 0.802$

Pearson correlation, active subscriptions vs. 30-day revenue (n = 1,000)

A strong, clean relationship. Startups in the top fifth for subscriptions earn on average over 125x what the bottom fifth earns — subscription count is one of the most reliable revenue signals in the whole dataset.

QUESTION 09

Pricing the Deal: What Are Sellers Asking?

262

listings currently for sale

2.3x

median revenue multiple asked

\$35,000

median asking price

Across the 262 on-sale listings with a stated multiple, buyers are typically asked to pay about 2.3x the underlying revenue figure — in line with typical small-SaaS acquisition pricing. Asking prices range all the way from \$0 up to \$10M, so the multiple is a far more useful yardstick than the sticker price alone.

QUESTION 10

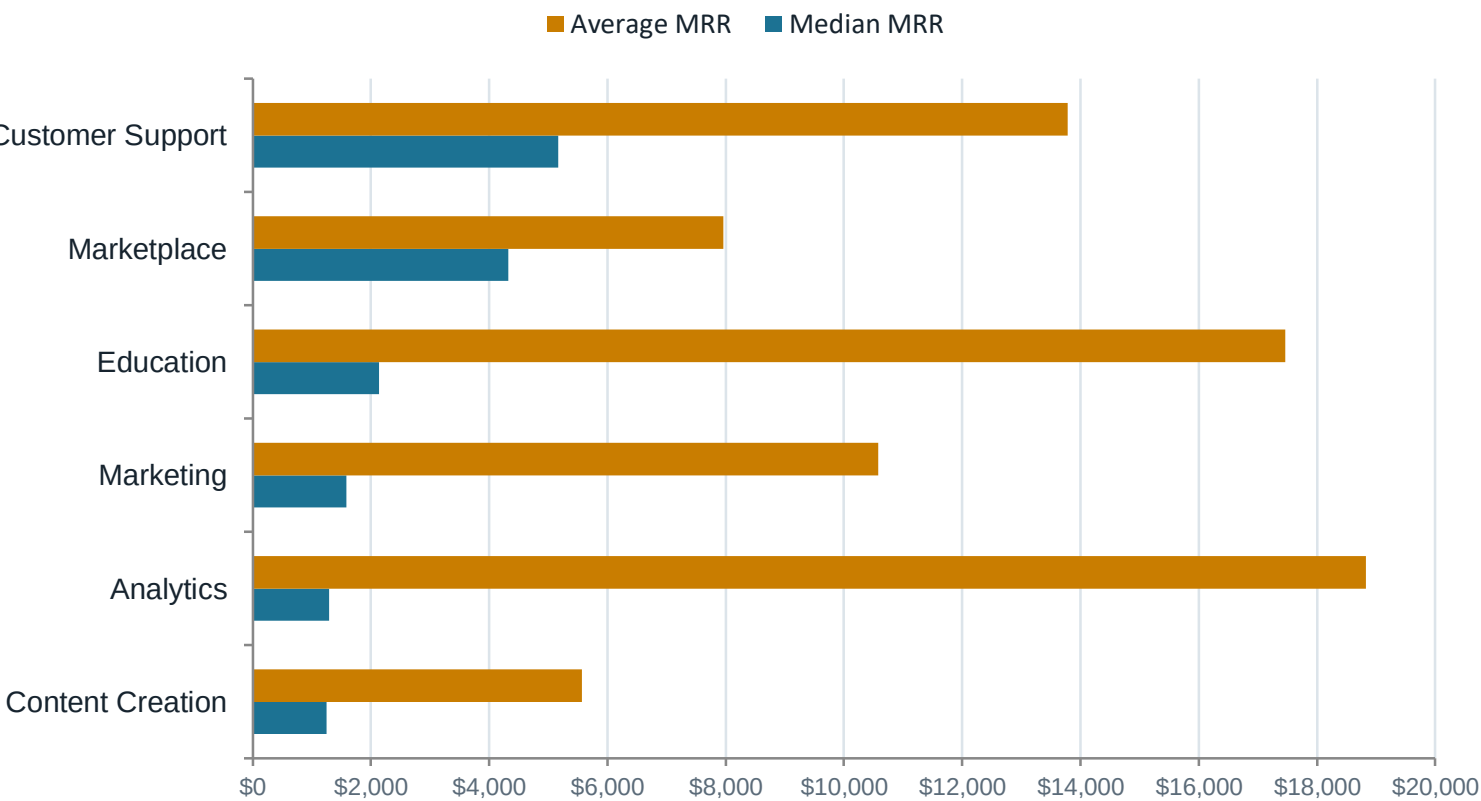
Putting the Data to the Test: Design Tools

- A** Design Tools has 12 rows, \$2,650 total 30-day revenue, and \$83 median MRR.
- B** Design Tools has 13 rows, \$31,797 total 30-day revenue, and \$83 median MRR.
- C** Design Tools has 12 rows, \$31,797 total 30-day revenue, and \$83 median MRR. ✓ CONFIRMED
- D** Design Tools has 12 rows, \$83 total 30-day revenue, and \$31,797 median MRR.

Verified directly against the 12 Design Tools rows: \$31,797 total 30-day revenue, \$83 median MRR.

QUESTION 11

Who's Really Thriving? Scale vs. Typical Success



\$446

AI's median MRR across 197 listings — vs. \$9,167 average

AI dominates total dollars simply by volume (197 listings). But its typical listing earns modestly — a few outsized winners pull the average far above the median. Categories like Customer Support, Marketplace, and Education have far fewer listings, but the typical business in them earns more.

QUESTION 12

Do X Followers Predict 90-Day Revenue?

First 11 rows of the dataset · 10 rows had both fields present

Startup	X Followers	90-Day Revenue
Stealth Company	0	\$131,432
Speak Silq	3,458	\$64,435
NOTE BOOSTER	2,428	\$276
VELA	0	\$0
LaunchGuard	400	\$203
Stealth Company	271	\$2,979
ImgX Studio	1	\$0
WRITING9	73	\$16,069
SimpleBankExcel	0	\$0
Faithwake	0	\$14.99

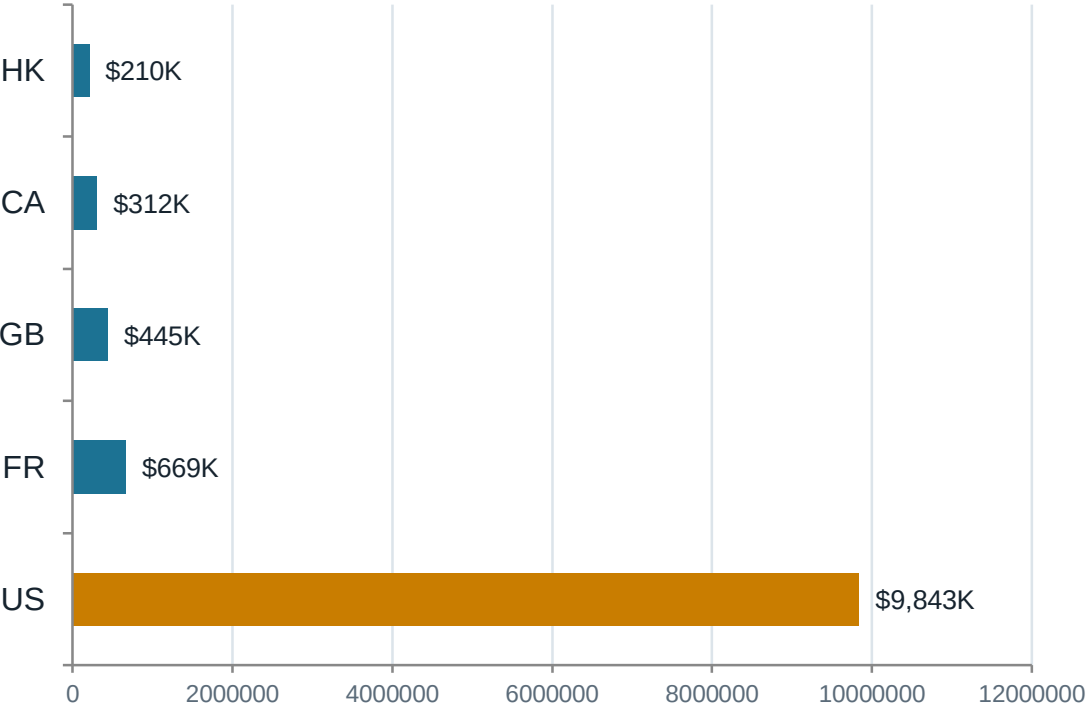
$r = 0.171$

Pearson correlation (n = 10)

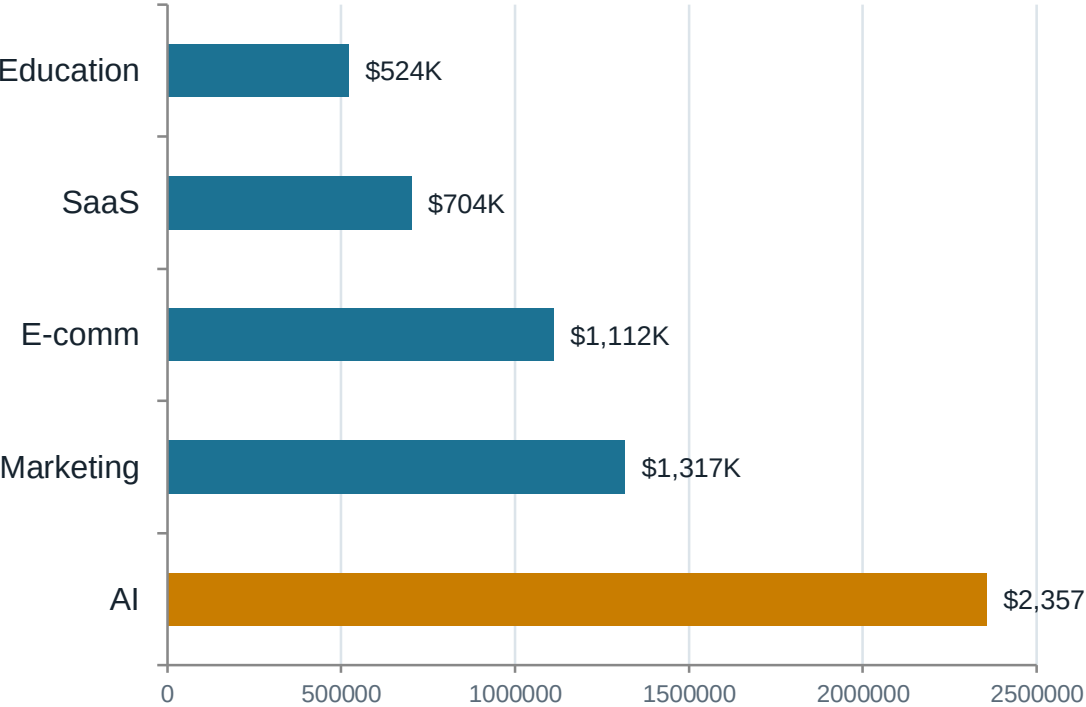
Practically no relationship in this tiny sample — the highest-revenue company here (“Stealth Company”) had zero recorded followers. With only 10 data points, this is far too small a sample to draw any real conclusion either way.

Where the Revenue Concentrates

TOP COUNTRIES BY 30-DAY REVENUE



TOP CATEGORIES BY 30-DAY REVENUE



What We Learned

1

Revenue is concentrated, not evenly spread

A handful of large listings — and one dominant category, AI — account for a hugely disproportionate share of total revenue.

2

Scale isn't the same as typical success

AI wins on total dollars through sheer volume; categories like Education and Customer Support show stronger typical (median) performance per company.

3

Anonymity correlates with higher earners

“Stealth” and unnamed listings are a small minority but earn well above the per-company average — anonymity looks more like a choice made after success, not before it.

4

Subscriptions are a reliable revenue signal; followers aren't

Active subscriptions correlate strongly with revenue ($r = 0.802$); X follower counts show no such pattern in this data.

5

The data has real gaps

Domain Rating, traffic, and growth fields are blank for a large share of listings — genuine diligence is still required before acting on any single row.



Thank You

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